

DWELLING IN LUXURY

Delhi has seen the highest number of expensive properties sold in the past 18 months

Location	Sub-market	Area (sq. ft)	Price (₹ crore)	Property type
Mumbai	Juhu	25,000	183	Bungalow
Delhi	Kautilya Marg, Diplomatic Enclave	13,950	137	Bungalow
Mumbai	Bandra	11,266	119	Quadruplex
Delhi	Vasant Vihar	18,000	100	Bungalow
Delhi	Sunder Nagar	7,794	85	Bungalow
Delhi	Shanti Niketan	9,000	84	Bungalow
Delhi	West End	10,800	82.5	Bungalow
Delhi	Vasant Vihar	11,250	70	Bungalow
Hyderabad	Jubilee Hills	23,796	48	Bungalow
Delhi	Vasant Vihar	5,400	45	Bungalow

DATA FOR APRIL 2021-AUGUST 2022; SOURCE JLL INDIA, INDUSTRY

ditionally upmarket areas like Golf Links, Jor Bagh and Sunder Nagar remaining high in demand, majorly due to limited availability and lush greens, along with the presence of the city's VVIPs and political power resting here. Localities in South Delhi, like West End, Vasant Vihar and Shanti Niketan, too attract luxury buyers due to good social and physical infrastructure," says Samantak Das, Chief Economist and Head of Research and REIS, India, JLL. Golf Course Road in Gurugram, for instance, attracts HNIs, MNC expats and corporate executives, chiefly due to its proximity to the city's central business district, along with world-class amenities being offered by the developers in the area. Bungalows in South Delhi and Central Delhi, with plot area ranging between 5,400- and 10,800 sq. ft, are preferred, while for apartments, it ranges between 5,000- and 8,000 sq. ft.

MOREOVER, THE RECENT rush for luxury homes has got significant impetus from start-up founders and stakeholders as well, those who have made big bucks, says Das. As per Amit Goyal, Chief Executive Officer-India, Sotheby's International Realty, a US-based luxury real estate firm that deals in such properties, influx of money from VCs resulting in a large number of millionaires and billionaires in the Indian start-up landscape, has played a crucial role. "Of late, we are increasingly noticing a lot of professionals, like lawyers, architects and doctors,

coming into the luxury market. Additionally, there is an influx of start-up founders, who have sold their stakes recently and made big bucks," Goyal says.

Recently, names such as Vijay Shekhar Sharma of Paytm and the Chaudhrys of Aakash Educational Services, who made fortunes by selling their stakes, have purchased homes in locations like Golf Links and Vasant Vihar in Delhi. While Sharma of Paytm spent ₹82 crore for a Golf Links home, Chaudhrys' Vasant Vihar property is estimated to have cost ₹100 crore. Zishaan Hayath, Founder of Toppr, which was acquired by edtech major BYJU'S last year, has bought a 4,000-sq. ft sea-facing apartment in Bandra for ₹41 crore.

As per JLL's analysis, markets like Bengaluru, Chennai and Pune, which were missing from the luxury realty landscape even a few years ago, are now making their mark. Even Hyderabad's Banjara Hills and Jubilee Hills are witnessing deals worth up to ₹48 crore. Data shows, across the five markets—Delhi-NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Pune and Chennai—at least 50 luxury projects are being developed, with prices ranging between ₹8 crore and ₹49 crore. That is, however, just the beginning. According to Prestige Group's Anish, while the luxury property market continues to remain limited, over the next five years the dynamics may change.

"In my view, the ₹1-1.5 crore unit size market, which is the most lucrative segment currently for us, will move up to ₹3 crore a unit. And the ₹3-crore units segment will become a ₹5-crore segment in the next five years," he says. **BT**

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